

Thursday, 28 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 31° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 29° 12°	MANCHESTER Rain 28° 14°	GLASGOW Overcast 24° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

An inquiry into student loan plans in England is looking into whether repayment terms are 'reasonable' for students.

This Treasury inquiry has already found that many people didn't fully understand the terms of their loans. It's a key focus as part of wider discussions around higher education finance.

EDUCATION · UK
- 2

A woman has admitted guilt in connection with a fatal XL bully attack which tragically took place in Bristol.

The incident, which happened in 2025, led to the death of 19-year-old Morgan Dorsett. It's a sad development in a case that has drawn national attention.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A man has been charged following the fatal shooting of an award-winning farmer in Derbyshire earlier this year.

The body of 23-year-old Charles Kinston was discovered in a field back on January 29th. This is an ongoing investigation into a very serious incident.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 With the summer festival season starting and temperatures set to rise, it's time to think about keeping cool outdoors.

This bank holiday weekend could see some soaring temperatures, so festival-goers will want to be prepared. There are some handy tips doing the rounds to help you stay comfortable.

FESTIVALS · THIS WEEK

2 Fans of Rik Mayall will be pleased to hear unseen material is set to feature at a new comedy festival this week.

The nine-day Rik Mayall Comedy Festival kicks off this Friday in Droitwich Spa. It promises to offer a fresh look at the much-loved comedian's work.

COMEDY · THIS WEEK

3 A 'raucous' debut novel, set entirely during one epic night out, is being hailed as a must-read.

Author Sufiyaan Salam, who has already worked with Stormzy and Elton John, has created quite a buzz with his new book. It sounds like a fantastic, immersive read to pick up soon.

BOOKS · NEW RELEASE

On the schedule

- 1 A new BBC Sport documentary is set to give us an unprecedented look at England football star Ella Toone.**
The film offers behind-the-scenes access as she prepares for her wedding, while also reflecting on a personal loss. It promises to be a very insightful watch.
FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Tottenham's chief executive, Vinai Venkatesham, has spoken exclusively about the need for a 'complete reset' at the club.**
In a wide-ranging BBC Sport interview, he addresses various issues the club needs to tackle. Fans will be keen to hear his thoughts on what's coming next for Spurs.
FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 England's women's cricket team has secured a dominant T20 series victory over New Zealand.**
They sealed the series 2-1 with a seven-wicket win in the final game. It was a fantastic display from the team.
CRICKET · UK
- 4 Crystal Palace are just one match away from securing their first ever European trophy in Wednesday's Conference League final.**
It's a massive occasion for the club and their fans. Everyone will be hoping they can bring the silverware home.
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1** **Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.
- 2** **Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 3** **More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 4** **Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 5** **Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 6** **Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 7** **British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 69% of Brits do THIS as soon as they get in from work. What?
ANSWER: TAKE THEIR TROUSERS OFF AND PUT PYJAMA BOTTOMS ON.

Q 39% of us have done THIS in a supermarket trolley aisle. What?
ANSWER: HAD A FULL DOMESTIC ARGUMENT.

TALK TOPIC

- **A survey says 30% of us have a 'forever favourite' meal we'd be happy eating every day.**
Talk-back: what's yours? And could you really eat it every day?
- **Researchers say the average person has 27 unread voicemails. We're voicemail-phobic.**
Talk-back: when did you last actually listen to one? And who left it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Sport.** A grassroots football club in the Lake District plays its home games on a pitch with a 1-in-12 slope at one end — the steepest legal gradient for organised football.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A 5-a-side league in Slough has banned all 'celebration sliding' after three players in one season tore their shorts and demanded refunds.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The plastic bits on the ends of shoelaces are called aglets.
- Penguins propose to their mates by giving them a pebble.
- Strawberries aren't actually berries, but bananas, watermelons and pumpkins are.
- Cats have a special collarbone that lets them always land on their feet — usually.
- The word 'set' has the most definitions of any word in the English language — 430.
- The longest English word without a vowel is 'rhythms'.
- Ketchup was sold in the 1830s as medicine.
- Hippos secrete their own natural sunscreen — a reddish, oily substance.

On this day

Day 148 of the year, 217 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Croatia); Christian feast day: Bernard of Menthon; Christian feast day: Germain of Paris; Christian feast day: John Calvin (Episcopal Church). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1994 — Alec Benjamin, American singer and songwriter
- 1990 — Kyle Walker, English footballer
- 1944 — Sondra Locke, American actress and director (died 2018)
- 1944 — Patricia Quinn, British actress and singer
- 1966 — Roger Kumble, American director, screenwriter, and playwright
- 1985 — Carey Mulligan, English actress and singer
- 1956 — Jerry Douglas, American guitarist and producer
- 1952 — Roger Briggs, American pianist, composer, conductor, and educator

THE DAY TODAY

- 1996 — U.S. President Bill Clinton's former business partners in the Whitewater land deal, Jim McDougal and Susan McDougal, and the Governor of Arkansas, Jim Guy Tucker, are convicted of fraud.
- 1968 — Garuda Indonesian Airways Flight 892 crashes near Nala Sopara in India, killing 30.
- 2004 — The Iraqi Governing Council chooses Ayad Allawi, a longtime anti-Saddam Hussein exile, as prime minister of Iraq's interim government.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2017 — Former Formula One driver Takuma Sato wins his first Indianapolis 500, the first Japanese and Asian driver to do so. Double world champion Fernando Alonso retires from an engine issue in his first entry of the event.
- 1961 — Peter Benenson's article The Forgotten Prisoners is published in several internationally read newspapers. This will later be thought of as the founding of the human rights organization Amnesty International.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — The first meeting of the Constituent Assembly of Nepal formally declares Nepal a republic, ending the 240-year reign of the Shah dynasty.

- 1995 — The 7.0 Mw Neftegorsk earthquake shakes the former Russian settlement of Neftegorsk with a maximum Mercalli intensity of IX (Violent). Total damage was \$64.1–300 million, with 1,989 deaths and 750 injured. The settlement was not rebuilt.
- 1948 — Daniel François Malan is elected as Prime Minister of South Africa. He later goes on to implement Apartheid.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 149 of the year, 216 days left in 2026. Today Army Day (Argentina); Ascension of Bahá'u'lláh (Bahá'í Faith) (Only if Bahá'í Naw-Rúz falls on March 21 of the Gregorian calendar); Christian feast day: Bona of Pisa; Christian feast day: Hypomone (Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Noel Gallagher, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1954 — Robert Beaser, American composer and educator
- 1992 — Gregg Sulkin, English actor
- 1962 — Carol Kirkwood, Scottish weather presenter
- 1959 — Steve Hanley, Irish-English bass player and songwriter
- 1958 — Annette Bening, American actress
- 1972 — Laverne Cox, American actress and LGBT advocate
- 1975 — Mel B, English singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — One World Observatory at One World Trade Center opens.
- 1990 — The Congress of People's Deputies of Russia elects Boris Yeltsin as President of the Russian Soviet Federative Socialist Republic.
- 1974 — SETA, a Finnish LGBT rights organisation, is founded in Helsinki.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2021 — A Cessna Citation I/SP crashes into Percy Priest Lake in Tennessee, killing all six people on board, including actor Joe Lara and his wife Gwen Shamblin Lara.
- 1973 — Tom Bradley is elected the first black mayor of Los Angeles, California.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		